

admin rights, and tasks performed by the system itself. Resultantly, to alter or access critical items to the system, admin rights are required. This way, nothing gets messed up by mistake.

To modify system files on Ubuntu, type “`sudo`” or “`gksudo`” to get the equivalent of Administrator rights. In other distros, you switch to “`root`” or “`super-user`,” which performs the same function until you log out.



Super user

Be warned that altering file permissions in either of these cases might cause applications to stop operating and accidentally transfer file ownership to the root user (rather than the owner) and make the system less safe (by granting more permissions). Resultantly, unless it is required or you realize what you are doing, it is best not to modify permissions for files—particularly system files.

File permissions are in existence to provide users with a basic level of protection. Learning how they operate will assist you in setting up essential sharing in a multiuser environment, securing “public” files, and detecting when system file ownership issues arise. **d**